





1. Ayushmann Khurrana and Neena Gupta in *Badhaai Ho*, where his 50-something mum's pregnancy embarrasses her grown-up son

2. Kriti Sanon in surrogacy flick *Mimi*

3. Ranveer Singh stands up for his wife and the girl child against his domineering dad in YRF production *Jayeshbhai Jordaar*

Rocket on ZEE5; Nushrratt Bharuccha plays an expectant mother who battles ghosts and orthodox mindsets in the horror movie *Chhorii* on Amazon Prime.

PRODUCTION VALUES

The 2022 slate is as full. Kicking off the year is Yash Raj Films' *Jayeshbhai Jordaar* in which Ranveer Singh's character stands up for his pregnant wife (Shalini Pandey) and their girl child, much to the fury of his domineering father (Boman Irani), who wants a boy. The themes of pregnancy and 'Save the girl child' apart, first-time director Divyang Thakkar is hoping this film redefines the action hero in Hindi cinema. "It doesn't have to be about '*maar-dhaad*' but something as small as standing up to your father and saying 'I want this girl'," says Thakkar. "He's not even a *PadMan*-like guy who wants to change the world. He's someone who, in the course of his own journey, discovers what it means to be a man."

For screenwriter Jyoti Kapoor, writing *Good Newwz* was an act of catharsis. Her struggle "with getting pregnant" and dealing with "never-ending questions from relatives and strangers who poked their noses in our private lives" became the trigger, and humour the best weapon to "tell a difficult story". She hoped to make audiences "laugh at all the good, bad and ugly experiences" she had been through.

Good Newwz was also brave enough to have the Kareena Kapoor character freely broach the subject of sex, as she reprimands her husband (Kumar) for getting tired easily and not trying hard enough to have a baby. Jyoti finds the contradiction in Indians' awkwardness in talking about sex